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Benchmarking of European private investors networks

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1. The content of the deliverable

The “D4.1 (D16) - Benchmarking of European private investors networks” deliverable presents the benchmarking of different investors and financial networks at the European level realized by the DT4G consortium in the scope of the WP3. The deliverable is based on an analysis of different resources published either by the VCs themselves or by organizations providing such information to start-up communities. The deliverable will act as a tool having a double role:

- on the one side, it should allow the start-ups supported by the consortium, and generally speaking from the project community to get a clearer picture about the European VCs – organizations and networks – and to be able to identify the ones corresponding to their activities, development stage and growth strategy.
- on the other, it should allow the DT4G consortium to have a blueprint allowing to invite, beyond the members of their own networks, relevant stakeholders to its activities and to establish key partnerships allowing to support the DeepTech start-ups seeking to raise funds.

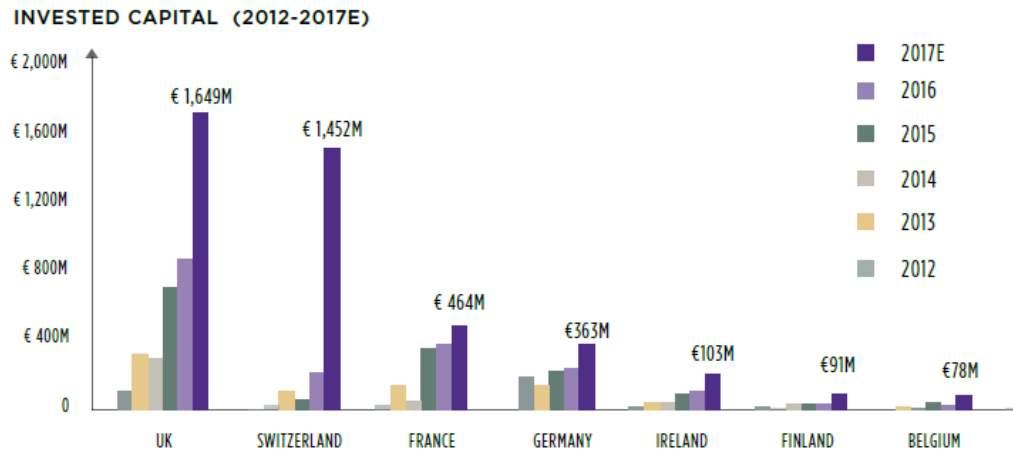
We will start our analysis with a focus on the DeepTech and the recent investments in the field before analyzing the different organizations and networks investing in the field.

2. A focus on DeepTech and DeepTech investments

Despite having lost the tech start-up battle, Europe is back in the arising DeepTech game due to its strong R&D assets, the existing infrastructures and the associated top level talent [Maghsoudnia-2017]. Furthermore, the harmonized regulation and the common market represent a potential differentiating asset [Maghsoudnia-2017]. As a result, investments are booming in Europe: “since 2015, VC investments into Deep Tech are growing x3 faster than overall tech start-ups and Deep Tech is leading since 2017” [Maghsoudnia-2017]. Indeed, DeepTech investments have increased from € 0.4 billion in 2012 to € 2.3 2016; the start-ups in the field are taking the lead and have raised € 4.6B with respect to their counterparts in the field of B2C where the overall investment level reached € 3.7B [Maghsoudnia-2017]. The distribution across the European countries is however not even: as expected, the UK is leading the way, followed in average by France¹ and Germany. The Figure 1 hereafter gives an overview of the evolution of investments in the field of DeepTech.

This raising interest and the associated level of investments doesn’t however solve the issues of DeepTech start-ups funding: a recent study prepared by the European Investment Bank for the “DG Research and Innovation” of the European Commission indicates that “there is a substantial market failure in the financing of deep-tech solutions associated with KETs companies” [Gigler-2018]. In this study, DeepTech are closely associated to the Key Enabling Technologies defined by the Commission.

¹ Switzerland comes on the second place in 2017 due to an outlier: Roivant, a Bio Tech which raised € 1.1 Billion.



Source: Dealroom, Artificial Intelligence, Deep Tech & Venture Capital in Europe (2017).

Figure 1: European DeepTech investments in leading ecosystems from 2012 to 2017 [Maghsoudnia-2017]

The inability to attract suitable funding is identified as one of the main reasons contributing to the European “Valley of Death” – the innovation gap consisting in the difficulty to exploit the knowledge base to create marketable goods and services, innovations able to achieve material scale and commercial viability [Gigler-2018]. As a reminder, we present in the Figure 2 hereafter the main sources of start-up funding according to their levels of development and the associated potential “valleys of the death”.

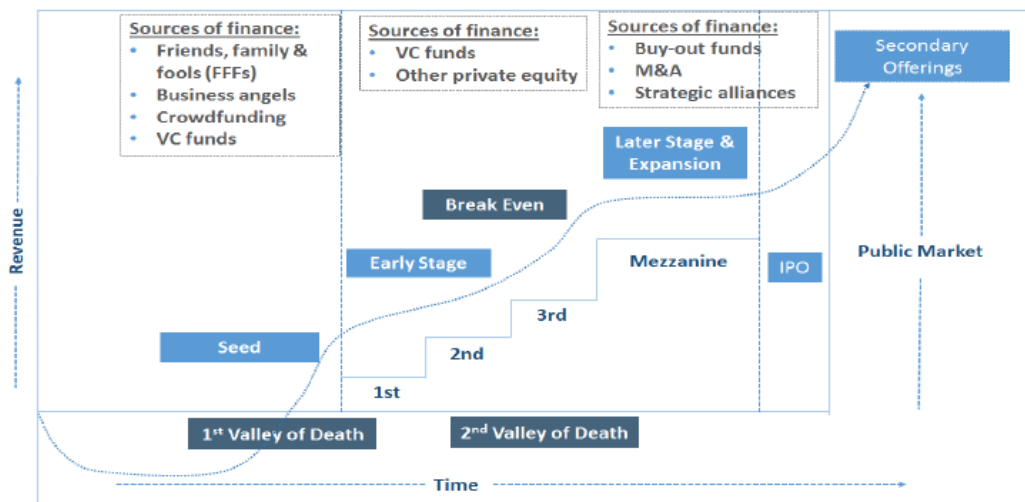


Figure 2: The founding sources available to start-ups according to the development stage [Whittle-et al-2015]

The Figure 3 below summarizes the main characteristics of DeepTech representing at the same time the main factors preventing them to access private capital easily. The inherent nature of DeepTech – on the one side potentially disruptive, but on the other capital intensive, slow to develop and commercialize and thus risky – is obviously one of the main reasons the start-ups from the domain are facing such challenges to attract capital. But the study puts forward additional reasons perhaps more important: the information asymmetry – the lack of adequate knowledge from the investors to

understand completely the very complex technological and scientific aspects of DeepTech and thus the difficulty to assess their disruptive potential is one of the key findings.

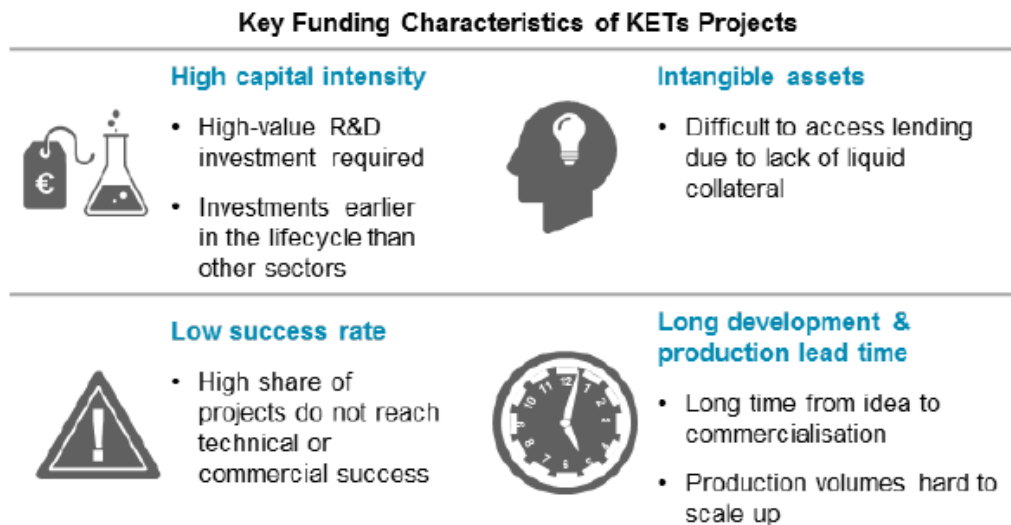


Figure 3: The main issues making more difficult the founding of DeepTech companies [Gigler-2018]

Even though the conditions in the financial markets appear to be exceptionally good, the development stage of the start-up seems to be one of the factors highly influencing its ability to access private capital. Companies having revenues below 50 M€ face difficulties in getting adequate funding and the challenge is even higher for companies having revenues less than 10 M€, independently of the Technology Readiness Level of their products. Even though other forms of financing, including bank lending, exist they're not well spread across Europe nor sufficient considering the needs. Also, despite exiting in large numbers, credit guarantees and research grant schemes are rather fragmented and too little coordinated across the different bodies [Gigler-2018].

By exploiting this information, the objective of the DeepTech4Good consortium is to understand better the financial markets conditions, to identify relevant stakeholders that started invested in DeepTech and to establish connections with them allowing to attract financial support for the start-ups involved in the acceleration programme. By exploiting the third pillar related to the corporate stakeholders involved in the project, the DT4G consortium could act as a reliable partner to close the loop between the DeepTech solutions offered by the start-ups, the acknowledgement of the potential of these solutions through the market needs expressed by the corporates and the associated private capital needed for their commercial upscaling.

3. The European VC landscape

3.1. An overview of the global European VC landscape

Before identifying the most relevant VCs at the European level, with a particular focus on the hubs covered by the DT4G consortium, we will start this chapter with an overall analysis of the most relevant European investments hubs. In its rapport on the impact of EIF on the VC ecosystem [Kraemer-Eis-etal-2018], the EIF provides an analysis of the geographic distribution of the investments realized

during its first 18 years of VC activity, leading to the identification not only the major European VC hubs but also of the most relevant investment patterns. The European Investment Fund supported 2,934 seed and start-up companies through about 3,300 investments carried by 214 VC firms through more than 320 VC funds.

Their analysis show that “consistent and persistent” investment channels/routes were pursued over time, by the same or several VC firms. The Figure 4 below shows the resulting network of investments and the cross investments between the major hubs – ecosystems having successfully proved over the period their ability to attract and to radiate venture capital. If some paths have a long history, like the one connecting Paris to Milan, others, for example all incoming and outgoing links from Berlin, have emerged quite recently [Kraemer-Eis-etal-2018]. It is also important to note that these links are bidirectional and highlight mutual exchanges between the major hubs. Beyond the EU soil, the key European hubs are also connected to the American VC ecosystem and, even if they’ve originated in Europe, 6.5% of the start-ups having attracted around 10% of EIF’s investments are currently US headquartered.

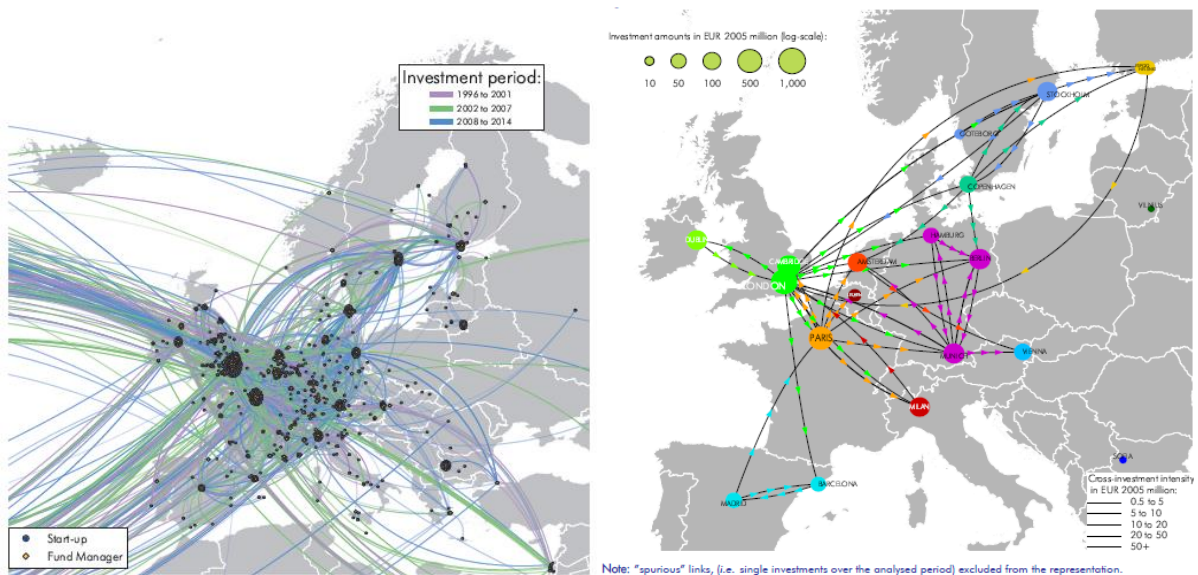


Figure 4: The network of VC investments backed by the EIF and the cross investments between the major hubs [Kraemer-Eis-etal-2018]

In addition to this mapping of the VC networks, the study offers a relevant ranking of the ecosystems, presented in below, that shows a very high correlation degree with the 2015 version of the European Digital City Index developed by NESTA². Full details about the analysis criteria are provided in the report; we will only highlight at this stage that almost 42% of all EIF-backed VC investments are cross-borders investments and 3 major hubs - London, Paris and Munich - represent 51% of all activities. These investments are also highly correlated with specific European policy objectives and initiatives and the most noticeable investments started occurring in the 2008-2014 period. If Paris, the focal point of the French ecosystem has strong links with the Southern Europe, Munich is a key city for the DACH are that integrates the Austrian ecosystem which is one of the pillars of the current project.

² <https://digitalcityindex.eu/methodology>

City (country)	Rank 1996-2001	Rank 2002-2007	Rank 2008-2014	Overall period rank
London (UK)	2	1	1	1
Paris (FR)	1	3	3	2
Cambridge (UK)	4	2	6	3
Berlin (DE)	8	13	2	4
Munich (DE)	6	7	4	5
Dublin (IE)	5	4	10	6
Milan (IT)	3		8	7
Stockholm (SE)		9	5	8
Amsterdam (NL)	9	6	7	9
Copenhagen (DK)		8	9	10
Vienna (AT)		10		11
Hamburg (DE)	13	15	11	12
Madrid (ES)	14		14	13
Barcelona (ES)			12	14
Helsinki (FI)	10		13	15
Espoo (FI)	12			16
Leuven (BE)				17
Goteborg (SE)				18
Sofia (BG)				19
Vilnius (LT)				20
Belfast (UK)		12		
Bristol (UK)		5		
Cologne (DE)			15	
Leipzig (DE)	15			
Lyon (FR)		14		
Manchester (UK)	11			
Reading (UK)	7			
Valbonne (FR)		11		

¹ Note: only ranking 15 or higher for time-windows, and 20 or higher for the overall period reported. Missing rankings indicate that the city did not classify among the top 15 for the specific time-window, or in the top 20 for the overall period.

Figure 5: The Top 20 EIF-backed VC hubs according to the volume of investments during the 1996 – 2014 period [Kraemer-Eis-etal-2018]

The analysis made by [Bpifrance-2016] shows an overall investment level of EUR 40 bn between 2007 and 2015, with a peak value of more than EUR 7 bn in 2007, distributed among more than 28,000 young companies. The Figure 6 hereafter illustrates, following the analysis made by BPI France, the evolution of the European investments and the number of deals for the different investment stages. Two critical aspects are mentioned with respect to these amounts: an important contribution of government agencies and the lack of official VC statistics, since the firms are not obliged to inform about their activities. In terms of application areas, three main sectors attract 60–70% of total VC: life sciences, computer & consumer electronics and communications. If the energy & environment sector played an important role until 2012 (10–16% of the investments), its importance decreased to only 4% in 2016.

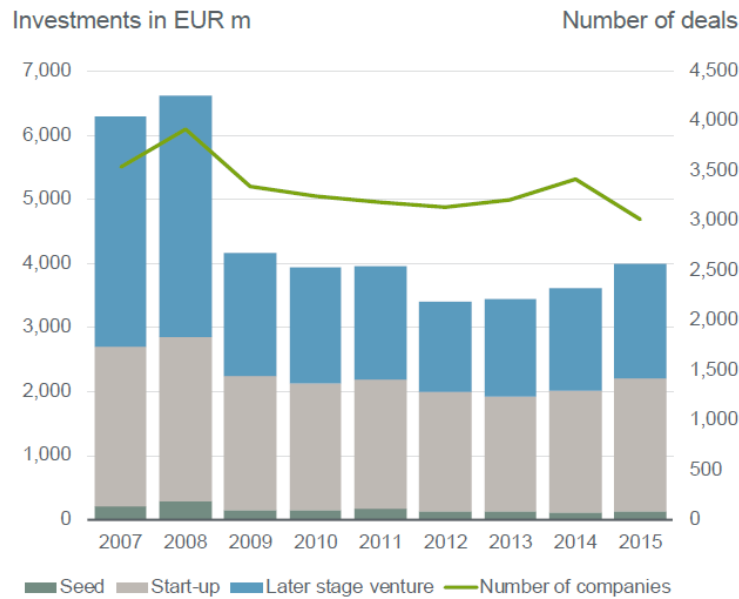


Figure 6: The size of investments and the number of deals between 2007 and 2015 according to the development stage of the start-ups [Bpifrance-2016]

In addition, a very interesting analysis of the investments realized in the different hubs has been made available by Techstars. The Figure 7 hereafter presents the map established by Techstars, showing the main European investment hubs, while a full list of major active investors is made available online. It has been implemented under the form of a Google Sheet, available through the following link: <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1neWbVEVm5nefBMw4xrx9eQLP4YTcfGf2OVuIL0QrZRE/edit#gid=0>. It is a very valuable tool, providing a starting point for the start-ups seeking to raise funds, since it provides an overview of the investors landscape, as well as indications about the investment stage of each fund and the areas covered. Analyzing the ecosystem according to each start-ups criteria is also possible through platforms such as Dealroom³; even though the use of the platform is not free, a trial period allows the start-up to get preliminary information. Additional information is also available from various sources at the national level; we will focus in the subsequent sections on the main VCs in the 4 hubs covered by the consortium.

³ https://app.dealroom.co/investors/f/country_experience/Europe

This map is a visualisation of the investment landscape across Europe. The circle size represents the number of investors in a location and the circle colour represents the amount of capital raised by startups since 2014.

You can find the full list of investors here:
techstars.com/investorsineurope

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3.2. The Austrian VC ecosystem

The Austrian startup ecosystem and consequently of the venture capital scene are very young despite a few “veterans” like Venture Capital Funds, BWIN, PONTIS Ventures and Gamma Capital Partners [Venionaire-2017]. Even though a national association for private equity industry and corporate finance service providers - AVCO⁴ exists from 2000 and represents today 80% of the Austrian Venture Capital market, most of the initiatives were launched by the state and a vicious circle was created by the fact that there weren’t enough successful startup founders to support further the ecosystem [Venionaire-2017]. Furthermore, the Austrian venture capital funds are rather small, the market not being enough differentiated and impacted by numerous regulatory constraints reducing the attractiveness for international VCs [Christopoulos-2015].

However, through recent initiatives like Start Europe and the Pioneers Festival, an ecosystem of investors, with both local and foreign players, begins to catalyze and starting to develop fast. [Venionaire-2017] prepared a recent map, illustrated in Figure 8 below, of the most active investors in Austria and additional information related to both regional and international investors is compiled in lists such as the one provided in [Romans-2014].



Figure 8: The Austrian venture ecosystem [Venionaire-2017]

To get a larger perspective, Austria should also be looked at in the context of the DACH area where similar stakeholders from the VC market are involved and additional information, such as the map available in [Ockenfels-2018] and presented in Figure 9 below, provides further insights about the various local and international investors that could be contacted.

⁴ <https://avco.at>

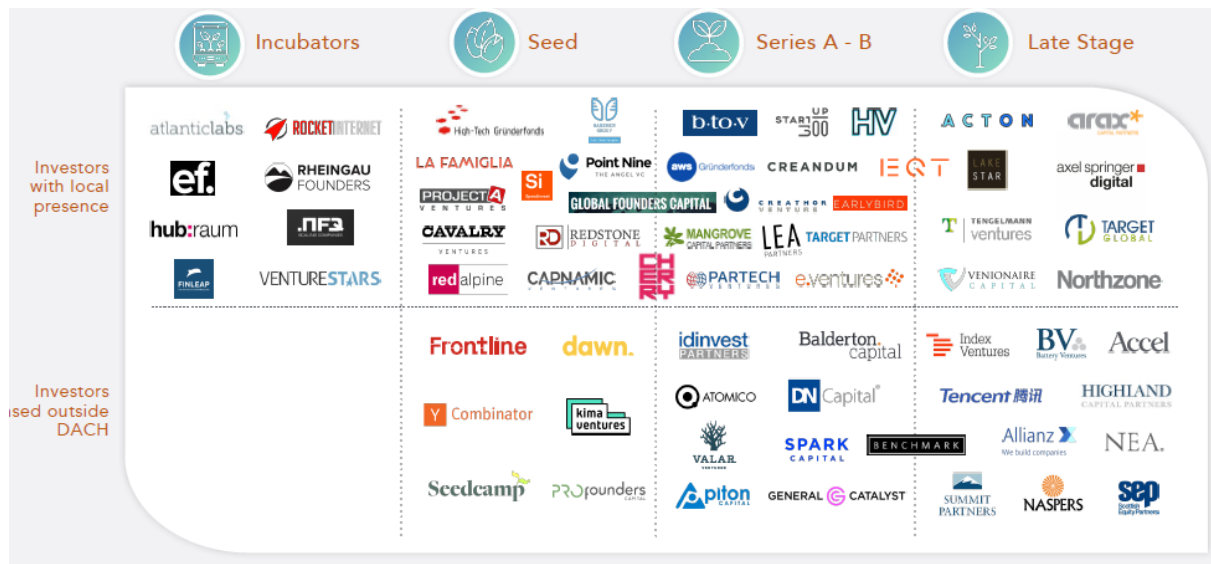


Figure 9: The landscape of venture funds in the DACH (Deutschland, Austria & Switzerland) region [Ockenfels-2018]

3.3. The French VC ecosystem

Although impacted by the economic crisis of 2008–2009, the French VC market is currently well structured and competitive [Bpifrance-2016], maintaining its leadership in the European VC landscape. Fundraising and investments have started to increase during the recent years and will continue to do so but the ecosystem is still facing some major challenges: “financial performance of funds, attractiveness for private/foreign investors, consolidation of actors and emergence of larger funds” [Bpifrance-2016]. The support of the French government, through BPI France, has largely contributed to structuring the ecosystem and creating incentives for the private players as well as impactful support measures for the start-ups. This is especially true in the case of DeepTech start-ups, where BPI France plays a key role through its direct support by means of tools such as the iLab⁵ contest aiming to support the emergence of academic spin-offs. Globally BPI France also manages direct funds to support strategic industries or company development stages for which the private funding is insufficient, it has created a “fund of funds”, and also supports actively the VC funds to increase their size and professionalize their activities, largely contributing to the creation of a viable ecosystem for VC investors [Bpifrance-2016].

Serena Capital, one of the main French VCs prepared a map of the French VC ecosystem, shown in Figure 10 below.

⁵ <https://www.bpifrance.fr/Toutes-nos-solutions/Aides-concours-et-labels/Concours-innovation/Concours-d-innovation-i-Lab>



Figure 10: An overview of the French VC ecosystem [Brayer-2017]

The funds have been classified by categories providing a clear orientation to the start-ups according to the development stage they focus on, the geographical coverage, technological orientation ...; full details are provided in the initial version of the list published in [Brayer-2016]. Beyond providing a global view and few key tips about the French ecosystem, Serena's article also offers a full list of more than 200 French VCs, available upon subscription through the following link: <https://serenacapital2.typeform.com/to/AMgy70>. The details are organized in a similar manner to the European VCs list provided by Techstars. An interesting additional list with foreign VCs investing in French start-ups is also provided in [Brayer-2016, Brayer-2017].

3.4. The German VC ecosystem

Germany, through its 3 main historical pillars – Berlin, Munich and Hamburg – is one of the key European VC hubs strongly linked to the European network [Kraemer-Eis-et al-2018]. But unlike its major British and French counterparts, where the center of gravity is focused on the capital, due to the well balanced regional and sectorial diversification, prosperous hubs are developed throughout the country and lead to a virtuous circle creating a thriving startup ecosystem [Burg-2018]. The Figure 11 below provides an overview of the overall German landscape of venture capital, with a classification of the stakeholders according to the investment/start-up development stage.

Peak levels of investments had been reached in the year 2000 but the VC-investments market crashed in 2003 [Bpifrance-2016]. Due to the strong government support in the mid-2000s, investments recovered until 2008 and reached a new peak in 2015 however the market is not yet ready to provide bigger later-stage investments [Bpifrance-2016].

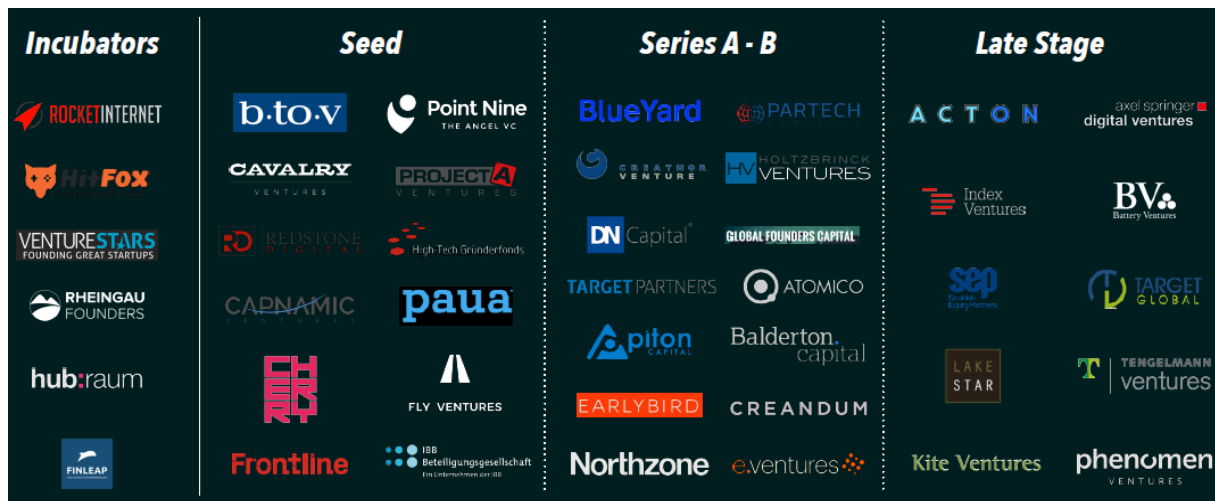


Figure 11: The landscape of German venture funds [Ockenfels-2017]

The German tech start-up industry also reached a record level of funding activity and successful exits (IPOs and Merger & Acquisition deals) in 2017 [EY-2018]. According to the data issued from the PitchBook Platform, in 2017 VCs invested €2.4 billion across 636 deals in Germany [Burg-2018]. A list of the top 10 most active German venture capital firms – illustrated in Figure 12 below, classified according to cumulative investments from 2012 to 2017, has been published by [Wan-2018].

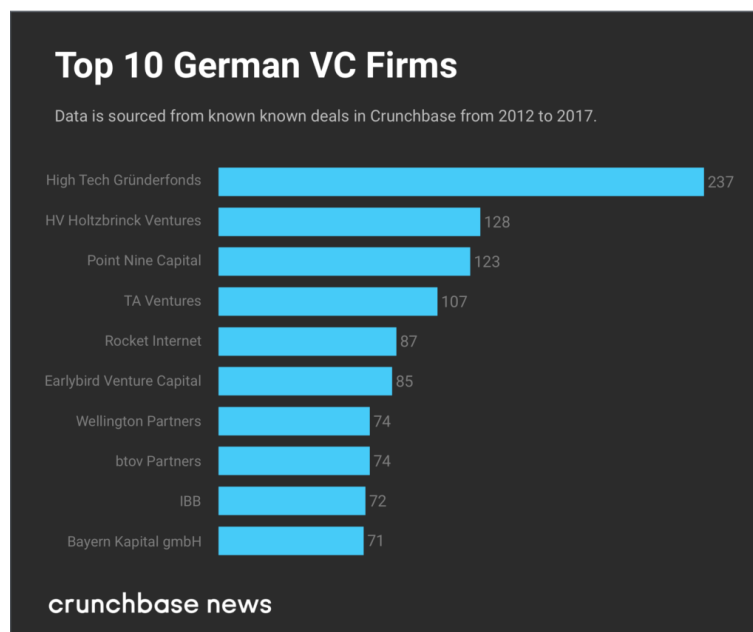


Figure 12: Top 10 German VCs investors by cumulative amounts between 2012 and 2017 [Wan-2018]

Due to its leadership position in the field of manufacturing and industry 4.0, as well as the momentum around disruptive technologies as well as the applications for emerging markets, the German ecosystem is also very well connected at the international level: through the support of organizations such as the German Accelerator Tech, the startups are developing their activities in the U.S. [Burg-2018], while the German ecosystem becomes very attractive for international investors - they accounted for around 54% of exits in 2017 [EY-2018]. Further insights issued form a complete analysis of the start-up and venture landscape are provided in the study published by [EY-2018]. Among the

key elements, it important to notice that the presence of international investors starts to enhance the later-stage funding environment in Germany while actually corporates remain the most relevant exit channel for German tech companies through M&A's [EY-2018].

3.5. The Spanish VC ecosystem

According to the analysis performed in [Bpifrance-2016], the Spanish private equity market is less developed than it is in other European countries the banking sector serving as the main catalyst for Spanish companies through debt financing. This orientation reflects on the one side the characteristics of Spanish companies, that are small on average, but also the suboptimal average size of Spanish private equity firms, having limited investment and thus growth abilities. As in the other countries, the global financial crisis impacted the investments in Spain until 2014 but the levels before the crisis had not yet been reached at the time. Aware of the importance of the private equity industry, the government has launched several initiatives to support its development as for example the creation of Fond-ICO Global in 2013, endowed today with up to €1.5 billion. Several additional Funds of Funds⁶ have been created and are currently in development, such as the FOND-ICOpyme growth and start-ups. In addition, several banks such as Santander or Bankinter have created their own investment funds.

Consolidated information with respect to the global Spanish VC ecosystem is difficult to find, we have however collected some data with respect to the most recurrent funds from sources presenting their activities; they are presented in the hereafter.

	Name of the fund	Creation	Number of deals	Total amount raised	Co-investments
	Active Venture Partners	2004	4 (since 2013)	€14 million	Seaya Ventures (Restalo)
	Axon Partners Group	1999	8 (since 2013)	€23,9 million	Bonsai Venture Capital (Akamon)
	Bonsai Venture Capital	1999	2 (since 2013)	€3,8 million	Axon (Akamon), Caixa Capital Risc (From The Bench)
	Cabiedes & Partners	late 90s	17 (since 2013)	€25,2 million	Vitamina K (Saluspot), Kibo Ventures

⁶ <http://www.axispart.com/en/web/axis/fond-icopyme1>

					(Nonabox), CCR (ByHours, Gigas)
	Caixa Capital Risc + Caixa Capital Micro II (€9 million) + Caixa Invierte BioMed II (€48.3 million)		18 (since 2013)	€20,2 million	Bonsai (From The Bench), Cabiedes (Gigas)
	ENISA	1982	685 (until 2012)	€96 million	
	Inveready	2008	45		
	JME Venture Capital		28 (2018)		
	Kibo Ventures	2011	16 (since 2013)	€24,7 million	Vitamina K (Promofarma, Ludei), Cabiedes (Nanobox)
	Lanta Digital Ventures	2013	2 (since 2013)	€50K	
	Nauta Capital		7 (since 2013)	€35 million	

	Seaya Ventures		5 (since 2013)	€23,4 million	Active (Restalo)
	Vitamina K		6 (since 2013)	€6,2 million	Kibo (Ludei, Promofarma), Cabiedes (Saluspot)

Table 1: An overview of the most active VC organizations in Spain^{7,8}

Other valuable sources exist, such as the list of VCs in Catalonia available on the regional government's web site⁹ or the list of more than 100 foreign VCs that have invested in Spanish start-ups, established by K Fund¹⁰.

⁷ <https://startupxplore.com/en/blog/looking-funding-spain-active-vc-firms>

⁸ <https://apiumhub.com/tech-blog-barcelona/venture-capital-investors-spain>

⁹ <http://catalonia.com/startups-in-catalonia/startup-ecosystem/venture-capital.jsp>

¹⁰ <https://blog.kfund.vc/a-list-of-109-venture-capital-firms-that-have-invested-in-spanish-startups-2acc1bdf336d>

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